

WOMEN IN INFRASTRUCTURE



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Ms. Rojina Shrestha is an active Village Maintenance Worker (VMW) at Chap Khola Nagthali Lifting Drinking Water and Sanitation Committee of Sahidlakhan rural municipality in Gorkha. Under Purnima programme, she also worked as a skilled labor during construction phase of the water supply schemes.

Rojina had earlier worked with different drinking water intervention in her community to strengthen her financial condition. However, it grew as a passion to actively serve her community. She was able to hone her skills with involvement in Purnima water supply project, during which she also received seven-day training of VMW that gained her knowledge and confidence to work amongst male counterparts in the community.

“When User Committee decided to give me this responsibility of VMW, many people disagreed saying that the

job required lots of hard work and a female may not be able to do it. However, I broke all their stereotype and was recognized as the first woman to learn finest in training sessions among all participants.

During construction period, I worked as skilled labor. After completion of this scheme, three of the VMWs including me, received complete responsibility of operating the system, controlling pumping system, distributing water to community, joining the pipe when required, meter reading and collecting the water tariff among others.

I have more responsibility among the three of us and community people are happy with my performance. They feel comfortable in telling me their issues. Female community members ask me whether this work is very difficult, and I tell them that if we learn well, nothing is difficult.”



SAFE HOUSE – SECURED LIVELIHOOD

PURNIMA Housing-Plus Programme



House reconstruction site (left), and house after reconstruction with poultry shed (right)

“Punya’s wife is also the beneficiary of Purnima wash scheme- which saved her from daily grind of making several trips to the public tap – which was far away from her house.”

52 years Mr. Punya Pokharel hails from Nuwakot. He was born with deformed legs. His wife cannot hear. Their economic condition was very weak. Social taboos and discrimination had made their life more miserable and Earthquake 2015 made them homeless.



Although Mr. Punya received the reconstruction grant from the NRA, he was still living in a temporary shelter due to the lack of technical support on housing construction. Purnima helped him to build the house by providing socio

technical support and top up grant as per NRA guideline. He got the house but he had no income source. So, Purnima supported him a grinding mill which has been helping him to earn 10,000 per month. With the earning, Mr. Punya started poultry farming which is complementing their income.

The safe house and secured livelihood have improved the self-esteem. Mr. Punya is now, the chairperson of inclusive self-help group which project supported to form in the Palika.

Punya’s wife is also the beneficiary of Purnima wash scheme- which saved her from daily grind of making several trips to the public tap – which was far away from her house. More importantly, it had saved her from the daily harassment she used to subject to at the public tap.

The story couple sum up Purnima’s integrated approach and its impact on the housing reconstruction and recovery of the vulnerable people.

